

Integrations guide — NEDS tool ecosystem

The CRM connects to two other NEDS tools — **nedsdrishti.in** (Drishti) and **socialmediadost.com** (Social Media Dost / SMDost). This guide explains what flows automatically between the three tools, what each team member sees, and what to do when something doesn't look right.

This guide is for **managers and admins**. Sales, support and accounts staff will encounter the effects of these integrations in their day-to-day work — the relevant parts are called out in their own guides.

The three-tool picture

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CRM (source of truth)

Clients · Deals · Invoices · Payments · Tickets

▼ ▼

nedsdrishti.in socialmediadost.com

Service delivery Content production

Audits · SEO · Brief → AI content

Analytics · Posts → Approval → Posting

...

The **CRM** is where client relationships, money, and support live. Drishti is where the service delivery team runs audits, tracking and content scheduling. SMDost is where the content team creates AI-generated posts, gets client sign-off, and queues them for publishing.

Integration 1 — Client auto-provisioning when a deal is won

What it does: When a Deal in the CRM is moved to the **Won** stage, the client is automatically created in Drishti and SMDost within seconds. No manual re-entry needed.

What the team sees:

- Sales marks the deal Won → the CRM creates the client in both tools in the background.
- The client's CRM profile gains two internal IDs: **Drishti Client ID** and **SMDost Client ID** (visible in the client record's detail section).

- An **activity entry** appears on the client's CRM timeline confirming provisioning, e.g. **"Provisioned in Drishti (ID: drsh-xyz)"**.

If provisioning fails:

- Check the client's CRM activity feed — a failure note will appear there too.
 - Re-trigger by opening the Deal, moving it back to Negotiation, and then to Won again — the job is idempotent (it won't duplicate).
 - If repeated failures occur, check the server `.env` for `DRISHTI_API_URL` , `DRISHTI_SERVICE_KEY` , and `SMDOST_SERVICE_KEY` .
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Integration 2 — Brief approved in SMDost → draft invoice in CRM

What it does: When the content team marks all content in a brief as

Approved in SMDost, the CRM automatically creates a **Draft Invoice** for that client and notifies the accounts team.

What accounts sees:

- A bell notification: `"SMDost brief approved for [Client] — draft invoice ready to price."`
- A draft invoice appears for the client in the CRM (Invoices tab on the client profile). The line item is pre-filled with the service description; the accounts team sets the amount and sends the invoice.

What the content team needs to know:

- Make sure the client's SMDost account has the correct **CRM Client ID** set (done automatically during provisioning). If it's blank, the webhook has no way to match the brief to a CRM client and the invoice won't be created.
-

Integration 3 — Approved SMDost content → Drishti for scheduling

What it does: When a brief is fully approved in SMDost, each content item (caption + media) is automatically pushed to Drishti as a **Scheduled Post**. The Drishti team then reviews and confirms before the posts go live.

What the Drishti team sees:

- New posts appear in the Drishti posts queue with status `**Scheduled / Pending Approval**`.
- Platform mapping: Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, Twitter/X, TikTok, and Google Business posts each land on the correct platform account.
- Default scheduled date is the **10th of the brief's month at 9 AM**. The content team can set a specific date per item in SMDost before approving.

Nothing in the CRM changes for this flow — it runs between SMDost and Drishti directly.

Integration 4 — Drishti activity → CRM client timeline

What it does: When a post is **approved, rejected, or published** in Drishti, that event is written to the CRM client's activity feed.

What the team sees:

- Open any client profile → **Activity** tab → entries like:

"Drishti: post approved — 'Diwali offer caption'"

"Drishti: post published on Instagram"

- This means the CRM has a full picture of the client relationship — sales history, support history, and service delivery milestones — without anyone copy-pasting between tools.

Note: only clients with a Drishti Client ID will receive these events. The ID is set automatically when a deal is won (Integration 1).

Integration 5 — Monthly brief auto-creation

What it does: On the **1st of every month at 7:30 AM**, the CRM automatically creates a content brief in SMDost for each active project that has a Social Media or GMB service and a linked SMDost client.

Platform defaults per service:

Service	Platforms created
Social Media	Instagram (4 posts), Facebook (4 posts)
GMB	Google Business (4 posts)

What the content team sees:

- A new brief appears in SMDost on the 1st, ready to start producing content.

No one has to remember to create it.

- The brief title follows the format: **"[Client Name] — [Service] — [Month Year]"**.

Idempotency: if the command runs twice for the same month (e.g. a server restart), it won't create duplicate briefs — it checks the CRM activity log first.

Manual trigger (backfill):

```
```bash
php artisan app:create-monthly-briefs --month=2026-07
```
```

Run this on the server via SSH if a month was missed.

Integration 6 — Client portal single sign-on (SSO)

What it does: Clients who log into the NEDS CRM portal see a **"Your NEDS Tools"** section on their dashboard with buttons to open Drishti and/or SMDost — and they land already signed in, without a separate password.

Conditions for the button to appear:

- The client's CRM profile must have a **Drishti Client ID** (auto-set on deal

won) for the Drishti button.

- The client's CRM profile must have an **SMDost Client ID** for the SMDost button.

- The client must have a user account in the respective tool (created automatically on deal won).

How it works for the client:

1. Log into the CRM portal.
2. Click "**Open Drishti Dashboard**" or "**Open Social Media Dost**".
3. They are redirected and automatically signed into that tool.
4. The sign-in link expires after **10 minutes** — if the client reports a sign-in error, they should return to the portal and click the button again.

If a client can't sign in via SSO:

- Check that their CRM contact has a portal login (Clients → Contacts → invite if not).
- Check that the client's CRM profile has the correct Drishti/SMDost Client ID.
- Check that the client's user account exists in Drishti and is **active**.
- If issues persist, the client can log into Drishti or SMDost directly with their email and password.

Integration 7 — Drishti context link on support tickets

What it does: When a support ticket is about a client who is connected to Drishti, the ticket show page displays a blue "**Open in Drishti** →" link so the support agent can jump straight to the relevant Drishti view without searching.

The link is service-aware:

| Ticket service | Drishti link goes to |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| SEO or GMB | Client's audit list |
| Social Media or Performance Marketing | Client's optimization / content view |
| Any other / no service set | Client's detail page |

WhatsApp tickets: when a WhatsApp message creates a ticket and the client is linked to Drishti, the Drishti URL is also appended to the ticket description — so it's visible in wadesk.in as well.

Integration 8 — WhatsApp two-way reply (wadesk.in)

What it does: WhatsApp is a full two-way channel through the CRM, across **two separate numbers** run on wadesk.in — a **Support** line (post-sale, existing clients) and a **Marketing** line (pre-sale enquiries). Which line a message arrives on decides how the CRM routes it; wadesk.in tells the CRM which line via the `whatsapp_number` field on its webhook call.

- The CRM always matches the phone number to a client **first**, regardless of which line the message arrived on. A known client is never turned into a new Lead, on either line.
- **Inbound, Support line, known client:** opens a **Ticket** (channel = WhatsApp) — deduplicated per wadesk.in conversation, so replies in the same conversation don't create new tickets.
- **Inbound, Support line, no match:** a **Lead** is created instead (source = WhatsApp).
- **Inbound, Marketing line, no match:** a **Lead** is created (source = WhatsApp). This is a deliberate routing rule (owner-confirmed 2026-08-03): the marketing number is pre-sale by definition, so an unknown number messaging it surfaces where Sales/Telecaller will see it.
- **Inbound, Marketing line, known client:** never a Ticket and never a Lead — logged as a **Note on the client's own Customer record** instead, so the inquiry is still visible without being tracked as a fresh sales opportunity. (Fixed 2026-09-03, real incident: an existing client — NSS Secure Solutions — messaged the Marketing line and was wrongly filed as a brand-new Lead under the old "Marketing line always = Lead, even for a known client" rule.)
- **Deduplication (both lines):** one Ticket or Lead per wadesk.in conversation — later messages in the same conversation are added as replies/notes rather than creating a duplicate. A new Lead is auto-assigned to a sales rep the same way any other new lead is (see the AI features section).
- **Full conversation capture, both directions:** wadesk.in notifies the CRM of **every** message in a conversation, not just its opening one — this includes a later reply from the customer, a staffer replying directly from wadesk.in's own inbox (not just from the CRM), and wadesk.in's AI after-hours assistant. On a Ticket this appears as a normal reply in the thread, correctly attributed ("Client" for the customer, the actual staffer's name, or "AI Assistant (WhatsApp)"), and a customer messaging again on a Resolved/Closed ticket reopens it automatically. On a Lead it appears as a note, prefixed `[Sent via WhatsApp by ...]` for an outbound message so it's clear who said what. A reply the CRM itself sent is never echoed back as a duplicate — wadesk.in knows not to re-notify its own service-key sends.
- **Outbound, Tickets:** when a staff member replies on a WhatsApp ticket in the CRM (and the reply is **not** marked "internal note"), the CRM sends it back through wadesk.in on the Support line automatically.
- **Outbound, Leads:** Sales/Telecaller/Admin/Manager can reply to a lead over WhatsApp too — the note box on a lead's page has an opt-in ******Also

send as WhatsApp reply" checkbox (unlike Ticket replies, a lead note is internal-only by default; you have to explicitly choose to send it). Only shown when the lead actually has an open WhatsApp conversation to reply on. A sent note gets a green "Sent via WhatsApp" badge in the timeline.

- **Deal-Won handoff:** the moment a deal moves to **Won**, the CRM automatically sends the new client an approved WhatsApp template on the **Support** line — the actual handoff from the marketing conversation to the support one. Needs `WADESK_HANDOFF_TEMPLATE_NAME` set in `.env` and a matching template approved both in Meta Business Manager and on wadesk.in's Templates page; silently skipped (logged) until both exist.

- **Visibility Audit payment confirmation:** the moment someone pays for a Visibility Audit offer tier (`/offers/visibility-audit`), the CRM sends them an approved WhatsApp template on the **Marketing** line (`WADESK_MARKETING_NUMBER`) confirming the payment — same approve-then-set-env-var contract as the handoff message above, gated by `WADESK_VISIBILITY_AUDIT_TEMPLATE_NAME` .

What the team sees:

- A ticket tagged WhatsApp behaves like any other ticket — reply in the CRM as normal. Internal notes (the "internal" checkbox) are never sent to the customer — use these for team-only context.

- If a client can't be matched by phone number on the Support line, a **Lead** is created instead of a ticket (see above) — check the **Lead Generation** list rather than assuming the message was lost. If it's actually an existing client with an out-of-date phone number, fix the number on their client record and ask them to send another WhatsApp message so future replies open a proper ticket.

- A message on the Marketing line only lands in **Lead Generation** when the phone number doesn't match an existing client. If it does match a client, it's logged as a note on their own record instead — check the client's timeline, not Lead Generation, if you're looking for it.

If a customer says they didn't receive a reply:

- Ticket reply: check it wasn't marked as an internal note by mistake.
- Lead reply: check the "Also send as WhatsApp reply" checkbox was actually ticked — unlike Ticket replies, a lead note doesn't send by default.
- Check server `.env` has `WADESK_API_URL` and `WADESK_SERVICE_KEY` set — without these the outbound send is silently skipped (logged as a warning, never blocks the reply itself).
- wadesk.in outages never break the CRM reply — the message is just not forwarded; the staffer may need to resend once wadesk.in is back up.
- Who can actually see/reply to a conversation on wadesk.in itself (as opposed to whether the CRM sent it) is controlled entirely on wadesk.in's

own Agents page, not here — see Section 13 of the admin guide.

Integration 9 — Drishti marketing metrics feed the monthly wins note

What it does: the CRM's AI monthly wins note (see the AI features section in the Admin/Manager guides) pulls real marketing-delivery numbers from Drishti for clients Drishti manages — posts published, audits completed, and marketing action items done for the month, fetched from Drishti's `GET /api/clients/{id}/monthly-metrics` endpoint via the same X-Service-Key pattern as the other integrations. These are the same counts Drishti's own weekly client digest already computes, just totalled over a full month instead of a week.

What the team sees: no extra step — the monthly wins note simply mentions these numbers alongside the CRM's own (tasks/tickets/payments) when a client has a Drishti account linked. Nothing changes for clients without one.

If Drishti is unreachable: the call fails silently (logged as a warning) and the note still drafts from whatever the CRM itself knows. This integration can never block the monthly wins note from running.

Integration 10 — Meta Lead Ads webhook

Status: built, not yet configured — needs a Facebook Developer App, a registered Page, and a Page access token before it goes live. See Section 16 of the Admin guide for setup steps.

What it does: when someone submits a Facebook or Instagram Lead Ads form, Meta calls `POST /api/webhooks/meta-leads` — but that event only carries a `leadgen_id`, not the actual name/email/phone submitted. The CRM queues a job that fetches the real field data from Meta's Graph API

(`GET /{leadgen_id}?access_token=...`) and creates a Lead from it (source

Meta Ads). Deduped on `leads.meta_leadgen_id` — a redelivered webhook event never creates a second lead.

Auth (two different mechanisms, both required):

- `GET /api/webhooks/meta-leads` — Meta's one-time (and periodic) verification handshake. Authenticated by `hub.verify_token` matching `META_WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN` — no signature involved for this request.
- `POST /api/webhooks/meta-leads` — every real lead event. Authenticated by `X-Hub-Signature-256` (HMAC-SHA256 of the raw body, keyed with `META_APP_SECRET`), verified by `VerifyMetaWebhookSignature` middleware.

Field mapping: Meta's standard field names (`full_name` or `first_name` + `last_name`, `email` / `work_email`, `phone_number` / `work_phone_number`, `company_name`) map to the lead's core fields. Two

custom questions are opportunistically mapped too, so a Meta lead scores as well as a manually-entered one: an answer that exactly matches an active **Service** name (case-insensitive) sets the lead's service, and an answer to a question whose text contains the word "**budget**" — with a parseable number or range (e.g. "₹10,000–25,000") — sets the estimated value. Any other custom question is preserved as a note on the lead instead. See

[Admin guide → Setting up Meta Lead Ads](#)

for how to word the ad form's questions to hit these.

`utm_source` / `utm_medium` are set to a fixed `meta` / `paid_social` ;
`utm_campaign` stores the **ad's real name** as set in Ads Manager (fetched via one extra Graph API call, `GET /{ad_id}?fields=name`), falling back to the lead form's name if there's no `ad_id`, and finally to the raw `ad_id` / `form_id` if both name lookups fail — so the Lead Source Performance report's campaign breakdown reads like "SEO - Pune - July V2", not a numeric ID. That extra lookup is best-effort and never blocks lead creation: a failed or rate-limited call just falls back one step, silently.

What the team sees: no extra step once configured — the lead appears in **Lead Generation** with source **Meta Ads**, auto-assigned and AI-scored like any other lead (Phase A applies automatically).

If the Graph API call fails (expired token, deleted lead, rate limit): logged as a warning, no lead is created, and the job retries up to 3 times (60s backoff) before giving up silently — this must never break the webhook endpoint itself, which always responds 200 immediately after queueing.

Integration 11 — Telegram lead alerts

What it does: every new lead (any source) posts a short alert — name, phone number (or "not provided"), source, assigned rep (or "unassigned"), and a link back into the CRM — to one shared Telegram group via the Telegram Bot API. A second, always-on place for the team to notice a new lead land, alongside the in-app notification bell and the auto-assigned rep's own notification.

Setup: message **@BotFather** on Telegram, create a bot, and set the token it gives you as `TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN` . Add the bot to the team's Telegram group, send any message in that group, then open `https://api.telegram.org/bot<token>/getUpdates` and copy the negative number under `"chat":{"id": ... }` into `TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID` . See Section 13a of the admin guide.

If alerts stop arriving: check both env vars are set (silently skipped, logged as a warning, if either is missing — this must never block lead creation) and that the bot hasn't been removed from the group.

Integration 12 — Visibility Audit funnel: first invite, tracking, and WhatsApp recovery nudges

What it does: Meta's native Lead Ads form (Instant Form, filled inside Facebook/Instagram) captures a submitter's name/phone/email but never sends them anywhere — so for a Meta Ads lead tagged the **GMB** service, the CRM sends a first WhatsApp invite automatically the moment the lead is created (`App\Jobs\SendVisibilityAuditFirstInviteJob`, `WADESK_VISIBILITY_AUDIT_FIRST_INVITE_TEMPLATE_NAME`), showing them the offer for the first time. From there, the `/offers/visibility-audit` page and its checkout link are tracking redirects, not raw links — every hit logs which funnel stage a lead reached (landing page viewed, checkout/Payment Page viewed) so the CRM can tell a lead who never engaged apart from a lead who got close and dropped off. Sales/Telecaller can review the whole funnel — how many leads came in, were invited, viewed the offer page, reached checkout, and paid — plus the stuck-lead queue, any time on **Lead Generation → Audit Recovery** (see the Sales guide); the same stage counts also appear in the Monday-morning weekly owner digest. On top of that, a scheduled job automatically nudges a stuck lead over WhatsApp so recovery doesn't depend on staff noticing during office hours: `app:send-visibility-audit-recovery-nudges` runs every 30 minutes and, for any lead stuck at checkout 2+ hours or at the landing page 4+ hours with no nudge sent yet, sends an approved WhatsApp template on the **Marketing** line — `WADESK_VISIBILITY_AUDIT_RECOVERY_CHECKOUT_TEMPLATE_NAME` / `WADESK_VISIBILITY_AUDIT_RECOVERY_LANDING_TEMPLATE_NAME`, same approve-then-set-env-var contract as the handoff/payment-confirmation messages above. Each template's own CTA button (a WhatsApp "Dynamic URL" button, not a plain link in the message text) carries the lead back to the right funnel stage; a required "Stop promotions" button lets the lead opt out, since Meta classifies this as Marketing content, not a Utility message about an existing order. The first-invite template follows the same "Stop promotions"/Dynamic-URL-button/Marketing-category contract.

A lead is only ever invited once (`leads.visibility_audit_invited_at`) **and only ever nudged once per stuck event** — if they come back and drop off again later, that's a fresh nudge opportunity, but a single stall never sends the same message twice.

Only Meta Ads leads tagged the GMB service are invited — a Meta lead form for SEO, Website Design, or another service is left alone, since the Visibility Audit offer is specifically a Google Business Profile audit and inviting an off-target lead to it would read as spam, not help.

If invites or nudges stop arriving: confirm the relevant template name is set in `.env` (each one silently no-ops on its own until its var is

set) and that the template is still Approved in Meta Business Manager
and on wadesk.in's own Templates page — wadesk.in keeps its own copy of each template's approval status, which doesn't update automatically just because Meta approved it. Use wadesk.in's **Templates → Sync from Meta** button (Admin only) to pull the latest name/body/category/approval status (and, as of the first-invite template, whether it has a Dynamic-URL button) straight from Meta instead of re-entering it by hand.

Delivery-failure feedback loop (added 2026-08-23): wadesk.in's

`POST /api/send-template` response only confirms it **accepted** the send request — WhatsApp's real delivery outcome (e.g. Meta's "healthy ecosystem engagement" quality throttle, error 131049) arrives later, asynchronously, via Meta's own status webhook. Real incident that surfaced this: a first-invite to a Meta lead was accepted by wadesk.in but rejected by Meta minutes later, and the CRM's funnel dashboard kept showing it as a clean "Sent" forever, since nothing told it otherwise. Fixed on both sides: the 3 VA-funnel jobs (`SendVisibilityAuditFirstInviteJob` / `RecoveryNudgeJob` / `PaymentConfirmationJob`) now persist wadesk.in's own `Message.id` (returned in `/api/send-template`'s response) as `meta.wadesk_message_id` on their `VisibilityAuditTouch` row; wadesk.in's `handleStatusUpdate()` now calls back to a new CRM endpoint, `POST /api/webhooks/wadesk/message-failed` (`App\Http\Controllers\Api\WadeskMessageStatusController`), same Bearer-token trust boundary as the existing webhook), whenever a message it sent flips to `FAILED` — matched back to the exact touch by `wadesk_message_id` and downgraded to `success = false` with the real error attached. ****Requires** `CRM_MESSAGE_FAILED_URL` set in wadesk.in's `.env` ****** (reuses the existing `CRM_WEBHOOK_TOKEN`, no new secret) — without it, this silently no-ops and the gap this closes reopens (the rest of the funnel keeps working normally either way).

****Retry cap on the post-payment "audit in progress" nudge (added 2026-09-01):**** separately from the recovery/invite jobs above,

`App\Jobs\SendVisibilityAuditInProgressJob` / `SendVisibilityAuditInProgressEmailJob` send a ~30-minute-after-payment "work has started" update and are re-attempted every 15 minutes by `app:send-visibility-audit-in-progress-nudges` until they succeed. Real incident that surfaced the gap: a briefly unapproved WhatsApp template on 2026-08-27 caused the same purchases to be retried for ~75 minutes before self-resolving — harmless that time, but nothing would have stopped an indefinite retry storm had the misconfiguration lasted longer. Fixed with per-channel attempt counters (`visibility_audit_purchases.in_progress_whatsapp_attempts` / `in_progress_email_attempts`) and gave-up timestamps

(`in_progress_whatsapp_gave_up_at` / `in_progress_email_gave_up_at`) —

each channel stops retrying after 5 failed attempts and logs a warning

naming the purchase, independently of the other channel.

`VisibilityAuditFunnelMetrics::pendingInProgressNudges()` excludes a

given-up channel from future dispatch; already-logged failed

`VisibilityAuditTouch` rows are untouched and stay visible on the VA

Funnel Analytics message log for manual follow-up.

Integration 13 — Lead context for the wadesk.in after-hours AI assistant

What it does: before wadesk.in's after-hours AI assistant drafts a

reply, it now calls `GET /api/leads/context?phone= ...` on the CRM (same

Bearer token as the existing wadesk.in → CRM webhook, no new secret) to

pull the matching Lead's campaign, service, declared budget, other form

answers, and — if the lead qualifies for it — a Visibility Audit offer

link. The assistant uses this to name the actual campaign or goal a lead

mentioned instead of a vague "thanks for filling in the form," to ask a

lead to confirm their budget instead of repeating back an answer that

isn't really a number, and to hand out the Visibility Audit link as a

concrete next step rather than only promising a future follow-up.

Why it exists: a real Meta Ads lead's WhatsApp auto-message had a

garbled "budget" answer (the submitter's company name, not a number —

confirmed as a Meta-side form data issue, not a CRM bug), and the AI's

reply could only say "thanks for the form" because it had no idea which

form or what the lead actually asked for.

If replies still read generically: confirm `CRM_LEAD_CONTEXT_URL` and

`CRM_WEBHOOK_TOKEN` are set in wadesk.in's `.env.local` — like every other

best-effort call in this integration, a missing/failing lookup just falls

back to the previous generic reply rather than blocking the send, so this

degrades silently. The lookup only finds a match for a phone number with

an **open** Lead in the CRM — an existing client or a closed/converted

lead won't return context, by design.

Integration 14 — wadesk.in's goal-question flow writes back to the CRM's Lead

What it does: the same `GET /api/leads/context` lookup above now also

returns the Lead's `goal`, `website_url`, `gbp_url`, and a precomputed

`needs_link` flag. When a matched Lead has no goal yet, wadesk.in's

after-hours assistant sends the lead a WhatsApp interactive list asking

"What's their biggest goal?" (the same 4 options as the CRM's own Goal

picker — see `sales.md` / `telecaller.md`). Once the lead taps one, wadesk.in

calls a new `POST /api/leads/goal-capture` (same Bearer token) to write it

onto the Lead — and if the goal needs a Website/GBP link, the assistant asks for that next and writes it back the same way once given.

Why it exists: the owner wanted a lead who only ever messages on WhatsApp — never gets a call — to still go through the same goal-then-link-or-Sales-handoff flow a telecaller would walk them through live. Reuses the goal/link fields and `LeadGoal` enum built for the telecaller-facing side (see CLAUDE.md's decisions log) rather than inventing a parallel set on the wadesk.in side.

The "Not Sure" branch is a real hand-off, not just a reply: the moment `goal-capture` sets a Lead's goal to Not Sure — from wadesk.in or the telecaller UI — `LeadObserver` fires `LeadWantsExpertAdviceNotification` to the lead's owner (and telecaller, if assigned) with a bell notification linking straight to the lead. This is one shared trigger for both paths, not two separate "needs Sales" mechanisms.

If a lead never gets asked, or an answer never saves: confirm the same `CRM_LEAD_CONTEXT_URL` / `CRM_WEBHOOK_TOKEN` env vars above are set — this reuses that same trust boundary, no new secret. The question is only ever sent to a phone number the CRM already recognises as an **open** Lead (`needs_link` / `goal` come back `false` / `null` for anyone else), and only once per Lead — a Lead that already has a `goal` set (from any source) is never asked again. **Real incident (2026-09-09) worth knowing about:** having the right values in wadesk.in's `.env` isn't enough by itself — its `docker-compose.yml` also has to explicitly list every variable the app needs under the `app` service's `environment:` block, or Docker never actually passes it into the running container even though `.env` has it. This had silently broken several things at once (this integration, the after-hours AI's replies, and message forwarding to the CRM timeline) with no visible error, since every affected function is designed to fail silently when its variable is missing. If a wadesk.in integration seems to have stopped working after a config change there, check `docker compose exec app env | grep <VAR>` on the VPS before assuming anything else is wrong.

Integration 15 — Automatic + manual WhatsApp engagement for Meta Ads leads

What it does: two new outbound sends via the existing wadesk.in ``POST /api/send-template contract. First, App\Jobs\SendLeadWelcomeMessageJob`` fires automatically the moment any Meta Ads lead is created (except a GMB-tagged one, which gets `visibility_audit_first_invite_template_name` instead — never both) — a thank-you that also asks what time works for a quick call, deliberately specific rather than a generic "any questions?" so

the lead is likely to actually reply. Second, `App\Jobs\SendLeadCheckInJob` is triggered manually by staff via the  **Send WhatsApp check-in** button on a lead's own page, for re-engaging a lead who's gone quiet later.

Why it exists: Meta's native Lead Ads form never opens a real WhatsApp conversation with the submitter — until the lead sends a message of their own, WhatsApp's 24-hour session window stays closed and staff (or the after-hours assistant) can only reach them via further approved templates, not free-form messages. Both templates exist specifically to prompt a reply and open that window, rather than being informational messages in their own right.

Both are Marketing category (an unsolicited first/re-outreach, not a reply within an open conversation — same reasoning as `visibility_audit_first_invite_template_name`), each needs a "Stop promotions" opt-out button, and each takes two body variables: the lead's name, and their tagged service (or "your enquiry" as a fallback when none is tagged). See `config/services.php`'s `lead_welcome_template_name` / `lead_checkin_template_name` comments for the suggested body text to submit to Meta.

Idempotency: the automatic welcome is sent at most once per lead (`Lead.welcome_message_sent_at`). The manual check-in has no such limit — staff can send it again anytime — but the button applies a soft 24-hour cooldown (`Lead.last_checkin_sent_at`) so it stays a considerate nudge, not an accidental repeat blast to the same contact.

If a lead never gets the welcome message, or the check-in button no-ops: confirm `WADESK_LEAD_WELCOME_TEMPLATE_NAME` / `WADESK_LEAD_CHECKIN_TEMPLATE_NAME` are set in the CRM's own `.env` (not wadesk.in's — these sends originate from the CRM, the reverse direction of Integration 14 above) and that the named template is genuinely Meta-approved. Both jobs no-op silently (by design) until configured.

Checking integration health

All integration events leave a trace in the CRM:

| Where to look | What it shows |
|--|--|
| Client profile → Activity tab | Provisioning success/failure, Drishti events, brief creation |
| Client profile → Invoices tab | Draft invoices created by SMDost brief approvals |
| Tickets list → WhatsApp badge | Tickets auto-created from Support-line WhatsApp conversations |
| Drishti → Posts queue | Content pushed from SMDost |
| Ticket → replies | Outbound Support-line WhatsApp replies sent via wadesk.in |
| Lead Generation → source filter | Leads auto-created from Website, WhatsApp (both lines), and Meta Ads |
| Lead → notes → green "Sent via WhatsApp" badge | Outbound Marketing-line WhatsApp replies sent from a lead |
| Lead Generation → VA Recovery | Leads currently stuck at the Visibility Audit landing page or checkout |
| VA Funnel Analytics → Message log | A "Failed" row with a real Meta error reason (not just a bare wadesk.in HTTP error) confirms the delivery-failure feedback loop is working |

If any integration stops working, the most common causes are:

1. **Server `.env` out of date** — a key (`DRISHTI_SERVICE_KEY` , `SMDOST_SERVICE_KEY` , `PORTAL_SSO_SECRET` , `WADESK_API_URL` , `WADESK_SERVICE_KEY` , `META_APP_SECRET` , `META_WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN` , `META_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN` , `TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN` , `TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID` , etc.)

is missing or wrong.

Run `php artisan config:cache` after any `.env` change.

1. **Docker not restarted after env change on VPS** — use `docker compose up -d` (not `restart`) so the container picks up new env vars.

1. **Client has no external ID** — if the deal was won before integrations were live, the client won't have a Drishti/SMDost ID. Provision manually by going to the deal, setting it to Won again (if safe) or by asking your developer to run the provisioning job directly.